disingenuously, whether it was customary for Abrasimov to be present on such an occasion.'5

The following month, as a key figure in the deployment of Soviet strategy in Africa, Honecker embarked on a four-nation tour which began in Libya, where a year earlier his trusted lieutenant and heir apparent6 Werner Lamberz had been killed in a helicopter crash.7 From then on, Egon Krenz was groomed for high office and treated as 'crown prince' (more in the media of the Federal Republic than in the GDR), but as Günter Schabowski noted, Krenz 'never heard any confirmation of such an intention' from Honecker.8

Exploiting the propaganda potential of the Libya trip, Neues Deutschland reported that during the drive from the airport, 'thousands of Tripoli citizens gave the guests from the GDR a spirited welcome'. Ghaddafi said the German Democratic Republic and the Socialist Libyan Arab People's Jamahiriya fought together 'against colonialism, racism and Zionism'. Furthermore, he praised events in Tehran – where Ayatollah Khomeini arrived back from exile in triumph – as a victory of the Iranian people's revolution. Reporting on a banquet given for Honecker, Neues Deutschland noted applause and laughter when Ghaddafi gave the First Secretary a 'splendidly crafted Bedouin saddle and equestrian clothing embroidered with folk motifs as a gift'.

The following morning, a beaming Honecker arrived in Angola to sign a twenty-year 'Friendship and Cooperation Treaty' with President Agostinho Neto. Speaking to Luanda's parliament without notes, he condemned 'the devious attack' by Chinese troops on Vietnam and assured the 'brave Vietnamese people' of the full solidarity of the German Democratic Republic. From Luanda, he flew on to Zambia to inspect refugee camps, but ostensibly to meet Joshua Nkomo, leader of the 'Zimbabwe African People's Union', and favourite in the fight to overthrow Rhodesia's white government. Nkomo gave a lengthy briefing on the struggle 'against the racist Smith regime, for independence and the realisation of the right to self-determination'. In a statement carried by ADN, Nkomo looked forward to the day 'when we shall meet again in a free Zimbabwe'. ADN added, 'Such a meeting will not take place in a capital called Salisbury but in a